

Project management toolkit

Summary of the Project Management Phases and Tasks



Description

This phase commences with the inception of the project. It includes the business case and project justification which outlines the reasons for the project and its benefits, funding submission, scope and project cost estimates. Much of the work done here can be used in the project plan or be used in a funding submission. A project manager should be involved at this stage, otherwise, a PM should be consulted. Risks are identified and evaluated at this stage and a confidence level (or uniqueness score) should be determined to help the organisation decide if the project will be commenced.

The planning phase is where the project solution is further developed in as much detail as possible and the steps necessary to meet the project's objective are planned. In this step, the team identifies all the work to be done. (Including things like regulatory approvals). The project's tasks and resource requirements are identified, along with the strategy for producing them. The scope is defined, risks identified, stakeholder engagement and budget finalised. At the end of this phase, the PM will have a plan to deliver the project. This plan should be approved before delivery commences.

In the delivery phase, the project plan is actioned, and project deliverables are achieved. The designs are developed, and contractors are engaged. Progress is continuously monitored, and appropriate adjustments are made and recorded as variances from the original plan. Progress information is reported through regular team meetings to maintain control over the direction of the project. PM will compare the progress reports with the project plan to measure the performance of the project activities and take corrective actions.

During the final closure, or completion phase, the emphasis is on releasing the final deliverables to the customer, handing over project documentation to the project owner, terminating supplier contracts, releasing project resources, and communicating the closure of the project to all stakeholders. Project handover and project closure report are completed at this stage. The last remaining step is to conduct lessons-learned studies to examine what went well and what didn't. This will help future project teams in all phases of a project. Project sign-offs, handovers and approvals are completed at this stage.

TEMPLATES

- Checklist
- Basic Project Deliverables_Sample
- Basic Project Deliverables_Template
- Business Case
- Cost Estimation Calculator_Sample
- Cost Estimation Calculator_Template
- Cost Estimation Summary_Sample
- Cost Estimation Summary_Template
- Project Brief_Sample
- Project Brief_Template
- Project Proposal_Template
- Project Scope Statement_Template
- Work Breakdown Structure Template

TEMPLATES

- Checklist
- Risk Management Plan_Simple
- Risk Register and Risk Matrix_Detailed
- Risk Register Excel_Template
- Risk Register Word_Template
- Risk Heatmap_Simple
- Excel Project Planner
- Gantt Chart Excel
- Project Plan Template_Detailed
- Project Plan Template_Simple
- Communication Management Plan-Template

TEMPLATES

- Checklist
- Change Request Form
- Detailed Project Status Report_Template
- Excel Weekly Status Report_Template
- Report on a Page_Sample
- Project Change Log_Template
- Project Performance Report_Template
- Project Tracker Excel with Gantt Chart
- Traffic Light Schedule_Template

TEMPLATES

- Checklist
- Lessons Learned Summary_Template
- Post Implementation Review_Template
- Project Closure Report_Template